



Student Government Association Bylaws

Addendum E

Commented [1]: Seb's last edits : April 12th, 8:12PM
- Any changes to be made do in suggested mode (dont hide anything in edit mode as I will be looking hehe)

Student Organization Application Process (SOAP)

Lead

The SGA Assistant Vice President for Student Interests (AVPSI) shall be given the responsibility of successfully planning and leading the SOAP. Should the AVPSI be incapable of leading the SOAP, the SGA Vice President of Student Interests (VPSI) shall designate either themselves or the CSI Co-Chair (CCC) as responsible for the SOAP.

Should there be a vacancy for the position of AVPSI and CCC, the VPSI shall carry out the duties and responsibilities listed below until an appointment is made and confirmed.

Definition

Each semester, the AVPSI shall announce the beginning of the Interest Period. During this one week span, any individual interested in forming a Student Organization shall fill out the New Organization Request Form. This form can be found on the Student Government Association DuckLink portal.

Interview

Once this New Organization Request Form is complete, voting will occur as outlined below. Afterwards, a meeting will be scheduled between the proposer, the AVPSI, and a staff member from the Office of Undergraduate Student Life. This meeting will be roughly fifteen (15) minutes long, and will involve basic questions about the applying Student Organization as well as any follow-up questions regarding the filled-out Application Form. Following this meeting, the AVPSI and a staff member will hold a closed vote upon whether or not the proposed organization shall advance into the New Organization Process (NOP).

The vote shall consider, at a minimum:

- The individuality of the organization
- The mission statement of the organization
- The potential student interest for the organization
- The legality of the organization, and
- The expected on-campus effects of the organization

Commented [2]: Updates made in this second draft:
- Clarified AVPSI's existence and how they will lead the NOP and chair the new org subcom
- Made step 1 stuff required and made it so constitution must be approved before going to step 2!
- Made step 1 presentation either virtual OR in-person
- Step 1 and Step 2 non-responsive checkins can be done by a CSI-chosen representative
- Step 2 to Step 3 presentations will now be done in front of CSI, with an affirmation of the senate at the next meeting. The appeal presentation may be done in front of senate if senate chooses
- Made it the responsibility of the non-RSO subcom chair to present a list of non-RSOs and their recommended decision to CSI
- Added specific deadlines for steps 1, 2, 3 (72 hours in advance of CSI meetings, and the dynamic deadline for docket as established by secretary for Senate meetings)

Commented [3]: transition document for SOAP

Voting Outcomes

The proposed organization shall be voted on during two points. The first vote shall take place after the submission of the Request Form, and either the AVPSI, or staff member must vote in approval for the applying organization to be invited to the interview. The second vote shall take place after the interview, where the vote must be unanimous for approval for the organization to be inducted into the NOP.

Should the AVPSI and staff member unanimously agree during the second vote, they may choose to move a proposed organization to the Potential Non-RSO step. Should this happen, the proposed RSO will be immediately put underneath the Non-RSO Subcommittee, as defined below.

Commented [4]: Can we define was "RSO" means?

The proposed organization shall be removed from The New Organization Process if both parties vote against approval in the first stage or if at least one party votes against approval in the second stage.

New Organization Subcommittee

Any organization admitted into the NOP shall become a part of the New Organization Subcommittee, which shall be chaired by the AVPSI, who will provide guidance on advancement through the NOP. Once an organization reaches Step 3, they shall be reclassified into one of the 11 CSI standing subcommittees.

The purpose of the NOS is to provide an infrastructure for the SGA to unilaterally host workshops and seminars, as well as coordinate communication with all the Step 1 and Step 2 New Organizations.

There will be an exception to organizations who are classified as Potential Non-RSOs, which shall instead immediately be added to the Non-RSO Subcommittee.

Step One: The Starting RSO Period

The newly-approved Starting RSO shall now be required to:

- Develop positions for an Executive Board or other system of officials (E-Board);
- Think of purpose-relevant events
- Draft and finalize their constitution and have it approved by the Rules Committee per the procedure defined in the SGA Bylaws
- Establish a rough budget
- Quantify student body interest

Budgeting

No Starting RSO shall be eligible to budget for funds from the SGA.

Events

A Starting RSO shall be eligible to host events with the same procedure as a Training RSO. However, it is encouraged that the Starting RSO not host any events until advancing to step 3.

Presentation

When the above information is prepared, a meeting with the AVPSI is suggested to review the process. When the Starting RSO feels they have developed their club enough to move on to the next step, they shall be asked to create a video-presentation based on the provided template by the AVPSI. This recorded presentation shall be between 5 to 10 minutes, and will be sent to the CSI to be voted on. The AVPSI will communicate any questions posed by CSI to the Starting RSO before the vote is initiated. The setting of the vote may be through either digital or physical forum, so long as at least $\frac{2}{3}$ of the committee is present and casts a vote in acceptance or rejection. This presentation should contain the relevant information listed above. Following this meeting, the CSI shall hold a closed vote upon whether or not the proposed organization shall advance to Step Two.

- Any member of the CSI shall abstain from this closed vote if they are involved in the creation of the Starting RSO.

Should the Starting RSO choose, they may opt out of a video presentation and instead present physically at any meeting of the CSI. The presentation procedure shall be the same as that of the digital format.

Deadline

Should a Starting RSO choose to present in-person, they must submit their presentation to the AVPSI at least seventy-two (72) hours in advance of the meeting of the CSI in which they seek to present.

Voting Outcomes

The proposed organization shall become a Training RSO and continue to Step Two if the CSI votes in $\frac{2}{3}$ majority for approval. The CSI reserves the right to pass any organization regardless of their adherence to the above list of requirements.

Length

The Starting RSO Period, together with the Training RSO Period, will last no longer than one calendar year. If this limit is exceeded, the Starting RSO shall be automatically removed from The New Organization Process, unless there are extenuating circumstances that the CSI deem acceptable.

If the Starting RSO fails to receive a $\frac{2}{3}$ majority on their first presentation, the CSI shall discuss and decide the status of the Starting RSO. The options include but are not limited to: allowing the organization to have another opportunity to present, or removing the Starting RSO from the NOP. If the Starting Organization fails to receive a $\frac{2}{3}$ majority on their second presentation, they shall be removed from the NOP. The CSI reserves the right to reject any organization regardless of their adherence to the above list of requirements.

Non-Response

Six months into the combined period, the AVPSI will communicate with organizations and subsequently determine if an organization requires a check-in meeting to discuss progress on the StepOne requirements and remind the organization of the timeline. This check-in meeting shall be conducted by a chosen representative from the CSI.

Should the representative find a Starting RSO non-responsive to multiple communication attempts, the CSI shall be alerted to all relevant details of the organization. If the CSI upholds the representative's opinion by simple majority, the representative shall alert the organization of their impending dissolution.

- If the organization responds within one week, the Starting RSO shall be required to meet with the chosen representative from the CSI to determine if they shall remain in The New Organization Process.
- If a week passes with no response, the Starting RSO shall be automatically removed from The New Organization Process.

Step Two: The Training RSO Period

The Training RSO shall now complete the following tasks:

- Finalize E-Board positions and fill it with individuals
 - Each prospective E-Board individual must meet the Office of Undergraduate Student Life's qualifications as defined in the Student Organization Handbook.
- Hold a minimum of two interest meetings
 - Create a Ducklink event for the interest meetings by request through the Office of Undergraduate Student Life, which can be initiated through a form under their DuckLink page.
 - Attendance must be taken at each of these meetings. Organizations must directly upload the attendance to the DuckLink Event created by the Office of Undergraduate Student Life.
 - A minimum of 10 Stevens undergraduate student members must attend each interest meeting. Between both meetings, a minimum of 20 unique Stevens undergraduate students must have attended.
 - Prospective E-Board members are not considered in the general body count.
- Obtain a faculty advisor
 - Consent must be provided via a signed Advisor Consent Form found on the SGA Ducklink page under documents. The form should be sent to the training SO's Student Life liaison and the AVPSI.
- Draft a list of, and budget for, theoretical events
 - The budget should be well-itemized and provide an accurate estimation of the funding likely to be requested each semester as a full-status RSO.
 - Creation of a secondary budget which provides an accurate estimation of the funding likely to be requested each semester as a Probationary RSO is encouraged.

Budgeting

All Training RSOs shall be eligible to receive a maximum of \$225 from the SGA per semester. All budgeting practices shall be held to the standards and guidelines of full-status RSOs. Training RSOs must contact the Budget Committee Senate Co-Chair or Assistant Vice President of Finance to receive guidance on the purchasing procedure for Step 2 Organizations.

Presentation

Once it has been deemed by the AVPSI that the Step 2 Organization has completed all the listed requirements, the Training RSO shall be contacted regarding the next steps.

The Training RSO shall be invited to attend a CSI meeting. The Training RSO shall receive a 15-minute time slot to present their candidacy for Probationary RSO status to the Senate. A maximum of 10 minutes shall be reserved for a formal presentation; the difference shall be allowed for the CSI to ask questions of the presenting body. This presentation should contain the relevant information listed above. Immediately following their presentation, the CSI shall hold a closed vote regarding whether or not the proposed organization shall advance to Step Three.

Deadline

The Training RSO must submit their presentation to the AVPSI at least seventy-two (72) hours in advance of the meeting of the CSI in which they seek to present.

Voting Outcomes

The Training RSO shall become a Probationary RSO and continue to Step Three if the CSI votes, by simple majority, in favor.

Once a decision has been made, it must be reaffirmed via simple majority of the Senate during the next available session. Should the Senate disagree with the decision of the CSI, they may choose, by simple majority, to impose a different decision.

The Training RSO shall be given, at most, two opportunities to present in front of the CSI. Should the Senate choose, the second presentation may instead take place during a Session of the Senate, following the same procedure as outlined above.

Length

The Training RSO Period, together with the Starting RSO Period, will last no longer than one calendar year. If this limit is exceeded, the Training RSO shall be automatically removed from The New Organization Process, unless there are extenuating circumstances that the CSI deem acceptable.

Non-Response

Should the AVPSI find a Training RSO non-responsive, the CSI shall be alerted to all relevant details of the organization. If the CSI upholds the AVPSI's opinion by simple majority, the AVPSI shall alert the organization of their impending dissolution.

- If the organization responds within one week, the Training RSO shall be required to present their current status to the CSI in order to determine if they shall remain in The New Organization Process.
- If a week passes with no response, the Training RSO shall be automatically removed from The New Organization Process.

Step Three: The Probationary RSO Period

As outlined in the section regarding the New Organization Subcommittee, a new Probationary Organization shall now be moved into one of the eleven standing subcommittees of the CSI.

The Probationary RSO shall now complete the following tasks:

- Request a DuckLink portal via the form under the Office of Undergraduate Student Life DuckLink Page. This form shall also check the eligibility of the current EBoard based on the requirements defined in the Student Organization Policies Manual.
- Request access to the proper room booking software by consulting the AVPSI.
- Fully update their newly-created DuckLink portal to the standards of the SGA and the Office of Undergraduate Student Life as per the Student Organization Policies Manual, which can be found on the Student Life Ducklink page.
- Utilize DuckLink to formally track Stevens undergraduate student attendance at all events of the organization.
- Submit a ticket to the Department of Information Technology requesting the formation of a Stevens email alias with current E-Board members being the recipients of the alias.
- Prepare a budget reflecting any expected changes as a full-status RSO.
- Attend all subcommittee meetings hosted by their Subcommittee Head.

The Probationary RSO shall now hold the rights, privileges, and responsibilities of a full-status RSO with the exception of budgeting practices. The Probationary RSO Period shall last at least one full calendar year, and shall last no longer than an additional six months. If this limit is exceeded, the Probationary RSO shall be automatically removed from The New Organization Process, unless there are extenuating circumstances that the CSI deem acceptable.

Budgeting

All Probationary RSOs shall be eligible to receive a maximum of \$1250 from the SGA per semester. All budgeting practices shall be held to the standards and guidelines of full-status RSOs. The elected treasurer of the Probationary RSO must now receive training from the SGA Budget Committee regarding the SGA Financial Policy, defined in Addendum E of the SGA Bylaws.

Ducks Leadership Series

The EBoard of the Probationary RSO will be required to fulfill the requirements of the Duck Leadership Series, as defined in the Student Organization Handbook, in the academic semester following the approval of the said new organization to Step 3. At no earlier point shall they be mandated to fulfill these requirements.

Presentation

When a full calendar year is nearing completion and the above information is prepared, a meeting with the AVPSI is suggested to review the process. The Probationary RSO is invited to attend any subsequent SGA Senate meeting. The Probationary RSO shall receive a 15-minute time slot to present their candidacy for full RSO status to the Senate. A maximum of 10 minutes shall be reserved for a formal presentation; the difference shall be allowed for the Senate to ask questions of the presenting body. This presentation should contain the relevant information listed above. Immediately following their presentation, the Senate shall vote upon whether or not the proposed organization shall advance out of The New Organization Process.

Deadline

The Probationary RSO must submit their presentation to the AVPSI before the deadline to add items to the Senate Docket has passed. This deadline is to be determined by the Secretary of the SGA.

Voting Outcomes

The Probationary RSO shall become a full-status RSO and graduate from The New Organization Process if the Senate votes in favor by simple majority. Organizations that pass the Senate's vote will be considered thereafter as full-status RSOs, unless the organization exists within the Non-RSO subcommittee. In this case, the organization will be considered a funded Non-RSO, and will follow the procedure as outlined in the Non-RSO section.

If the Probationary RSO fails to receive a simple majority in favor of full-status RSO, the SGA Senate shall conduct a discussion on the status of the Probationary RSO. The SGA Senate reserves the right to impose, but is not limited by, any one of the following repercussions upon the organization:

- Reinstatement as a Training RSO.
 - The newly-reinstated Training RSO shall keep their DuckLink portal and email alias, should they choose.

- Extension of the Probationary RSO Period for an explicitly-stated amount of time, to be decided by the SGA Senate.
- Removal from The New Organization Process.

Non-Response

Should the AVPSI find a Probationary RSO non-responsive, the CSI shall be alerted to all relevant details of the organization. If the CSI upholds the AVPSI's opinion by simple majority, the AVPSI shall alert the organization of their impending dissolution.

- If the organization responds within one week, the Probationary RSO shall be required to present their current status to the SGA Senate in order to determine if they shall remain in The New Organization Process.
 - The Probationary RSO will not be forced to present for full status candidacy at this presentation.
- If a week passes with no response, the Probationary RSO shall be automatically removed from The New Organization Process.

Potential Non-RSO

Definition

A New Organization may be classified as a Potential Non-RSO when the CSI believes that said Organization does not fall under the standard definition of an RSO, but is still eligible to receive Student Activity Fee (SAF) funding as dictated by the budget policy, outlined in Addendum E to the SGA Bylaws.

Tasks

The Potential Non-RSO shall now complete the following tasks:

- Finalize E-Board positions and fill it with individuals
- Quantify student body interest.
- Finalize their constitution
 - Use of the Sample Constitution provided by the SGA is encouraged.
 - The Potential Non-RSO does not need SGA approval of its constitution but must be able to present the document.
- Obtain a faculty advisor
 - Consent must be provided via a signed Advisor Consent Form found on the SGA Ducklink page under documents. The form should be sent to the training SO's Student Life liaison and the AVPSI.
- Establish a rough budget

Budgeting

No Potential Non-RSO shall be eligible to budget for funds from the SGA.

Presentation

When the above information is prepared, a meeting with the AVPSI is suggested to review the process and encourage the Potential Non-RSO to contemplate their subcommittee assignment. When the Non-RSO feels they have developed their club enough to move on to the next step, they shall be invited to attend the subsequent Senate Session. The Potential Non-RSO shall receive a 15-minute time slot to present before the Senate. A maximum of 10 minutes shall be reserved for a formal presentation; the difference shall be allowed for the Senate to ask questions of the presenting body. This presentation should contain the relevant information listed above. Following this meeting, the Senate shall hold a closed vote upon whether or not the proposed organization shall become a funded Non-RSO.

- Any member of the Senate shall abstain from this closed vote if they are involved in the creation of the Potential Non-RSO.

Voting Outcomes

The Potential Non-RSO shall become a funded Non-RSO if the Senate votes in $\frac{2}{3}$ majority for approval. The funded Non-RSO shall be given the ability to request funding from the SGA, and consult the AVPSI for the following:

- DuckLink Portal, via a form under the Office Undergraduate Student Life DuckLink page, which shall also serve to verify each EBoard individual via the criteria outlined in the Student Organization Handbook.
- Room Booking Software Access
- Email Alias, by contacting the Division of IT

The Senate reserves the right to pass any Potential Non-RSO regardless of their adherence to the above list of requirements.

If the Potential Non-RSO fails to receive a $\frac{2}{3}$ majority on their first presentation, they shall remain a Potential Non-RSO and receive another opportunity for presentation to the Senate at any following Senate Session. The Senate reserves the right to reject any organization regardless of their adherence to the above list of requirements.

If the Potential Non-RSO fails to receive a $\frac{2}{3}$ majority on their second presentation, they shall be removed from The New Organization Process.

Non-Response

Should the AVPSI find a Potential Non-RSO non-responsive to multiple communication attempts, the CSI shall be alerted to all relevant details of the organization. If the CSI upholds the AVPSI's opinion by simple majority, the AVPSI shall alert the Potential Non-RSO of their impending dissolution.

- If the organization responds within one week, the Potential Non-RSO shall be required to meet with the AVPSI to determine if they shall remain in The New Organization Process.
- If a week passes with no response, the Potential Non-RSO shall be automatically removed from the NOP.

Procedure

It will be the responsibility of the CSI to constantly reaffirm the status of all Non-RSOs via a check-in that evaluates whether or not the Potential Non-RSO is eligible to continue receiving SAF funding, as determined by the opinion of CSI.

It will be the responsibility of the CSI Non-RSO subcommittee chair to present a list of all Non-RSO's to the CSI and the recommended course of action.

Should a member of the CSI call a Non-RSO into question, the CSI may vote to impose an action as they deem fit by way of a $\frac{2}{3}$ majority vote. The respective Non-RSO shall have the ability to appeal the decision of the CSI to the Senate, who may either reaffirm the decision of the CSI or choose to impose its own action via a simple majority vote.